

Instructions for Administration:

8 Months Old

Note Ensure to wash your hands before handling the child and to handle the child gently.

Definitions

Plane: In reference to items requiring holding a body part on the same plane as another, this refers to being level to.

Prone Position: The prone position refers to lying horizontally with the face and torso facing down. The infant lies with knees drawn up under the abdomen with pelvis high. Head is turned to one side.

Supine Position: The supine position refers to lying horizontally with the face and torso facing up.

Ventral Suspension: The baby is placed in prone position and suspended in the air by a hand placed under the chest. The head hangs down with some flexion of elbows and knees.

1.1 Gross Motor

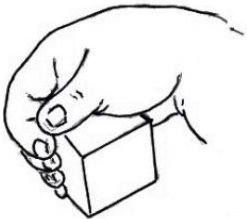
Notes If the child does not perform the gross motor item for their age, but performs a more advanced gross motor item, then the item specific for their age is considered normal.

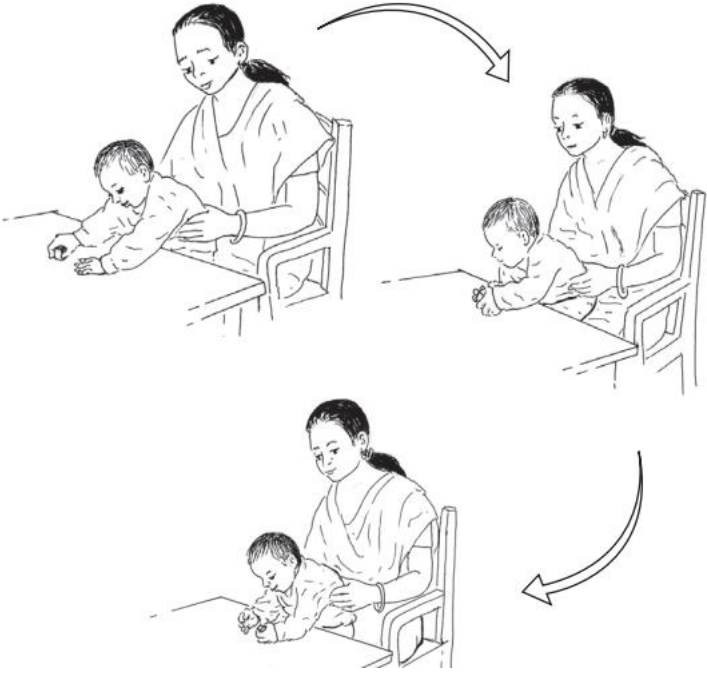
1.1.24	Readily bears full weight on legs	Age: 8 months
Materials	Padded Surface	
Instructions	Stand the infant upright, supported by holding the infant very lightly under the arms or by holding the infant's forearms.	
Response	The infant bears full weight of body on legs.	
Grading	Present Bears most of weight Minimal weight bearing No weight bearing	

1.1.25	Sits for a few seconds, unsupported	Age: 8 months
Materials	Padded Surface	
Instructions	Sit the infant on a padded surface on the floor. Give support by placing your hands around the infant's back. Gradually loosen your hold on the infant. 	
Response	Observe if the infant can sit unsupported for a few seconds.	
Grading	Present With self-support with straight back With self-support with partially rounded back With other's help, partially rounded back with steady head control	

1.2 Fine Motor Items

Note If the child does not perform the fine motor item for their age, but performs a more advanced fine motor item, then the item specific for their age is considered normal.

1.2.7	Palmar grasp	Age: 6 - 8 months
Materials	1 Block, Padded Surface	
Overview	The palmar grasp involves fingers pressing the object into the centre of the palm, thumb adducted.	
Instructions	Sit the infant on the caregiver's lap supported upright at a table. Place the block on the table in front of the infant and within their reach. If the infant does not immediately grasp the block, attract the infant's attention by tapping near the block, then quickly move your hand away. Test both hands separately.	
Response	Observe if the infant grasps the block using the Palmar Grasp or the Radial-Palmar Grasp. Either grasp is accepted and scored present.	
Grading	Present Clumsy Attempts (touch) No reaching	
Reference	Palmar Grasp 	Radial-Palmar Grasp  <i>The fingers on far side of object press it against opposed thumb and radial side of palm.</i>

1.2.8	Transfers object	Age: 7 - 8 months
Materials	2 Blocks	
Instructions	Sit the infant on the caregiver's lap supported upright at a table. Place one block on the table in front of the infant within their reach and allow the infant to grasp the block. Offer another block to the hand holding the first block.	
Response	Observe if the infant transfers the first block from one hand to the other. 	
Grading	Present Attempts (hands to midline, but no transfer) Hands do not reach midline No attempt	

1.3 Vision Items

Notes When smarties or 100s & 1000s are required for Vision items, select colours that contrast with the green cloth.

- Use: Yellow, Orange, Red
- Avoid: Green, Blue, Purple

Near vision and watching adults are evaluated separately, but only near vision is considered for the scoring of domain severity. When scoring vision of the child, fixation on objects placed on the tabletop is considered normal response.

1.3.9	Watches moving adult from 3 metres	Age: 3 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Stand in front of the infant at a distance of three metres and draw their attention. Move along an arc around the visual field of the infant and observe if the eyes move to track the moving adult. If no response, keep coming closer and observe the distance at which the infant's visual attention is engaged.	
Response	Infant watches moving adult from 3 metres.	
Grading	Present From 2m From 1m From <1m	

1.3.11	Fixates on smartie from 30cm	Age: 6 - 8 months
Materials	1 Smartie, Green Cloth If no response to Smartie: Yellow Block, Red Ball on String, Compact Mirror, Torch	
Instructions	The infant is seated supported upright on the caregiver's lap at a table, which is covered with a green cloth. Show a smartie to the infant and say "Ooh! Look at this beautiful thing". Place the smartie on one side of the table keeping the gaze of the infant on the smartie. Then, sweep your hand across the table holding the smartie, and release it at some point during the sweep of your hand across the table. Observe whether the infant fixates gaze on the released smartie or not. If no response, test with 2.5 cm block; then with the 6cm spinning red ball on string; then with a reflecting object; then a torch beam. 	
Response	Infant fixates gaze on smartie from 30cm.	
Grading	Present Fixes gaze on 2.5cm block from 30cm Fixes/follows suspended 6cm red ball on string from 25cm Fixes/follows on reflecting object or less	

1.4 Hearing Items

Note Soft whisper - 10 to 25 db; conversational speech - 25 to 55 db; crying baby - 55 to 65 db; rattle - 60 to 80db.

1.4.9	Distraction test at ear level - Rattle	Age: 7 - 11 months
Materials	Assistant, Rattle, Any Soundless Toy	
Instructions	The infant is seated on the caregiver's lap, supported upright. The examiner is the 'distractor' who sits in front of the infant at a distance of 1 to 2 metres. The assistant stands behind the caregiver and the child to provide a sound stimulus. The distractor encourages the infant's attention towards themselves by lightly playing with a 'soundless' toy, then swiftly putting it out of sight as a signal to the assistant to start the sound stimulus (rattle) at 1 metre from the ear at the infant's ear level and outside of their range of vision. The test is done in turn on each side of the infant.	
Response	The infant will turn their head and visually locate the source of the sound, equally on both sides.	
Grading	Present Questionable To loud rattle only No response	



1.4.10	Distraction test at ear level - Voice	Age: 7 - 11 months
Materials	Assistant, Any Soundless Toy	
Instructions	The infant is seated on the caregiver's lap, supported upright. The examiner is the 'distractor' who sits in front of the infant at a distance of 1 to 2 metres. The assistant stands behind the caregiver and the child to provide a sound stimulus. The distractor encourages the infant's attention towards themselves by lightly playing with a 'soundless' toy, then swiftly putting it out of sight as a signal to the assistant to start the sound stimulus (voice) at 1 metre from the ear at the infant's ear level and outside of their range of vision. The test is done in turn on each side of the infant.	
Response	The infant will turn their head and visually locate the source of the sound, equally on both sides.	
Grading	Present Questionable To loud voice only No response	



1.5 Expressive Language Item

Note This domain relies primarily on observation of infant vocalisations during the session:

- The examiner has to be vigilant about recording all infant vocalisations during the entire assessment so that none are missed.
- Interact and speak with the child to encourage vocalisations.
- If no vocalisations are made throughout the assessment, ask the caregiver if this is typical as it is not uncommon for young children to behave differently in new and unfamiliar situations. Document specific examples of vocalisations reported by the caregiver on the record form.

1.5.6	Vocalising consonant/vowel sounds e.g, “ba”, “ma”	Age: 6 - 8 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	These are combinations of vowel and consonant sounds used in one syllable. For example “ba” and “ma”.	
Response	Note the frequency with which the infant vocalises a combination of vowels and consonants in a single syllable.	
Grading	Vocalises consonant/vowel sounds Seldom Only Vowels No Vowels	

1.6 Cognition Items

1.6.12	Follows falling ball	Age: 7 - 8 months
Materials	Plastic ball or Red Woolly Ball	
Instructions	A woollen or soft plastic silent ball of about 7.5 to 10 cm in diameter is rolled across the table between the examiners two hands twice, then flicked gently over the outer edge of the table on the floor within the child's range of vision. If no response, repeat three times. If completing the assessment on a hard surface, the green cloth may be placed on the floor to silence the sound of the ball falling from the table.	
Response	The infant visually tracks falling ball within sight.	
Grading	Present Partial following (follows ball on the table only) Questionable Never	

1.6.13	Beginning to be aware of strangers and to modify responsiveness	Age: 8 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	This is a socialisation item based upon observation.	
Response	The infant might demonstrate signs of social withdrawal.	
Grading	Present Occasional Does not differentiate No awareness	

1.7 Behaviour Items

Note It is essential the examiner scores the Behaviour items based on their observations and caregiver report regarding sleep. Observe and record the child's behaviour according to the activities listed under this domain.

1.7.6	Sleep/awake rhythm	Age: 1 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Ask the caregiver about the infant's sleep patterns.	
Response	Score according to caregiver's recall. Over the first 3 months of life the total amount of sleep declines little, but the cycles are longer so that, by the age of 3 months, 70% of infants are sleeping right through the night. By 6 months, 80% of infants sleep through the night, but there are still 10% waking every night by the age of 1 year. By this age, the great majority of infants have established a stable pattern of sleep and wakefulness with a long sleep at night and a nap in the morning and afternoon. Mild, moderate and severe grades of response are: occasional disturbance, considerable disturbance, and constant problem. Either the infant is sleeping too much or is awake for longer periods of time.	
Grading	Normal sleep patterns Occasional disturbance Considerable disturbance Constant problems	

1.7.7	Displays positive affect most of the time	Age: 1 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Note the infant's affect.	
Response	The grading is done according to the degree of negative affect displayed during the assessment. Positive affect comprises of smiling, laughing, sound making that is perceived as the expression of excitement, happiness or pleasure. Negative affect includes fussing, pouting, whining, crying, vocal or physical expressions of anger.	
Grading	Displays positive affect Sometimes negative Mostly negative Constantly negative	

1.7.8	Displays normal periods of quietness	Age: 3 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	This item tests the child's quietness. Few children are so quiet that they are very unresponsive.	
Response	The infant is quiet, responsive, not restless.	
Grading	Displays normal periods of quietness Placid/Quiet Unusually Quiet Extremely Quiet	

1.7.9	Displays responsiveness to surroundings	Age: 3 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Observe if infant engages in visual, auditory, oral, or physical exploration. For example, trying to touch or hold objects.	
Response	Degree of responsiveness is noted. A curiosity towards new stimuli within the environment is normal.	
Grading	Present Most of the time Infrequent Never	

1.7.10	Good eye contact	Age: 3 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Note the frequency of eye contact the infant makes with the examiner.	
Response	The infant should be making eye contact with persons interacting with them.	
Grading	Present Most of the time Infrequent Never	

1.7.11	Good attention to tasks	Age: 6 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Observe the infant's focused attention and concentration towards a particular activity in the assessment. Some infants might have attention deficits or attention deficit / hyperactivity disorders that might express themselves at an early age.	
Response	The infant displays good attention to tasks during the assessment.	
Grading	Present Most of the time Poor attention but not hyperactive Poor attention and hyperactive	

1.8 Seizure Item

1.8.4	Seizures (provoked or unprovoked)	Age: 6 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Ask caregiver or check medical records to determine whether infant has ever experienced a seizure. Seizures are manifestations of neuronal injury due to excessive electrical activity in the brain. Any disturbance in the brain may cause seizures, which may be single or repetitive, and involves a sudden change in behaviour.	
Response	Consider typical if the child has not had a provoked or unprovoked seizure.	
Grading	No seizures (provoked or unprovoked) One or more than one typical febrile fit in the past year One or more than one unprovoked seizure/atypical febrile fit in past year More than one unprovoked seizure/atypical febrile fit in the past week	